

Mercedes-Benz Group AG (MBGn.DE)

2Q26 preview: Trimming estimates on softer China profitability; 2Q Cars margin still within guidance

MBGn.DE

12m Price Target: €65.00

Price: €45.11

Upside: 44.1%

Following Mercedes's release of 2Q26 wholesale volume and public pre-close call on July 14, in which the company expects 2Q Cars adj. EBIT margin to be in line with the full-year range (3-5%, GSe 3.4%, Visible Alpha consensus 3.5%), we revise our price target and estimates to reflect stronger US/Europe (+10%/+4% vs. previous GSe +1%/+2%), softer China volume (-30% vs. previous GSe -14%) and lower BBAC JV profitability (4.0% at FY26, cut from 6%). We now expect the company to report 2Q Group adj. EPS of €1.43 (vs. cons €1.29) and Cars adj. EBIT at €778mn or 3.4% margin (vs. cons €816mn or 3.5%). For FY26, we forecast Cars adj. EBIT margin at 4.0% (cons 3.7%). Mercedes is scheduled to report 2Q results on July 28.

■ **New products are gaining strong momentum, but China remains the key drag on volumes.** Group unit sales reached 418k in 2Q, down 8% yoy driven by declines China, partly offset by Europe and the US. Europe delivered positive momentum on the back of the new products CLA, GLB, and GLC, while the US was supported by the GLE and GLE Coupe. Electrification continues to accelerate, with BEVs up +51% yoy globally (+87% yoy in Europe or a 26% BEV share there) and the overall xEV BEV share reaching 13%. Demand for the electric CLA, GLB, and GLC is strong with orders extending into next year, and electric C-Class orders opened in May. Top-end vehicles came in at 58k units, affected by planned product changeovers and timing of availability, leading to 2Q TEV share at c.14%.

■ **Profitability is tracking within guidance across divisions, though reported earnings may be clouded by non-cash items.** For Cars, management expects 2Q adjusted EBIT margin within the full-year guidance range of 3-5% (GSe 3.4%, cons 3.5%), Vans adj. EBIT margin towards the upper end of the 8-10% range (GSe 9.2%, cons 9.0%), while Financial Services adj.

 **BUY**
Christian Frenes+44(20)7051-8641 | christian.frenes@gs.com
Goldman Sachs International**Monika Mengting Liu, CFA**+44(20)7051-7601 | monika.liu@gs.com
Goldman Sachs International**Shivam Kotecha**+1(332)245-7822 | shivam.kotecha@gs.com
Goldman Sachs India SPL

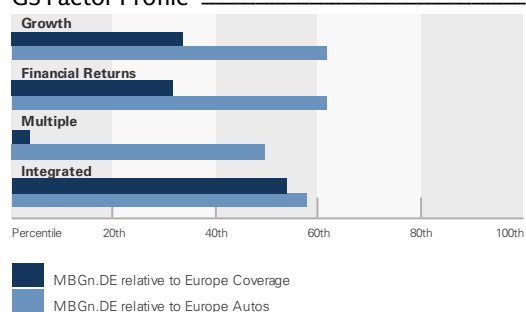
Key Data

Market cap: €43.4bn / \$49.5bn
Enterprise value: €66.0bn / \$75.3bn
3m ADTV: €137.2mn / \$159.4mn
Germany
Europe Autos
M&A Rank: 3
Leases incl. in net debt & EV?: Yes

GS Forecast

	12/25	12/26E	12/27E	12/28E
Revenue (€ mn) New	132,214.0	129,414.6	132,545.6	135,794.7
Revenue (€ mn) Old	132,214.0	130,918.3	134,085.7	137,382.0
EBIT (€ mn)	8,235.0	7,139.0	8,416.5	9,186.0
EPS (€) New	5.34	5.57	6.85	7.94
EPS (€) Old	5.34	5.81	7.41	8.41
P/E (X)	10.2	8.1	6.6	5.7
Dividend yield (%)	6.4	7.8	8.6	9.3
CROCI (%)	(0.7)	16.6	15.7	16.8
Net debt/EBITDA (X)	2.2	2.0	2.0	2.0
	3/26	6/26E	9/26E	12/26E
EPS (€)	1.49	1.43	1.30	1.35

GS Factor Profile



Source: Company data, Goldman Sachs Research estimates.
See disclosures for details.

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Mercedes-Benz Group AG (MBGn.DE)

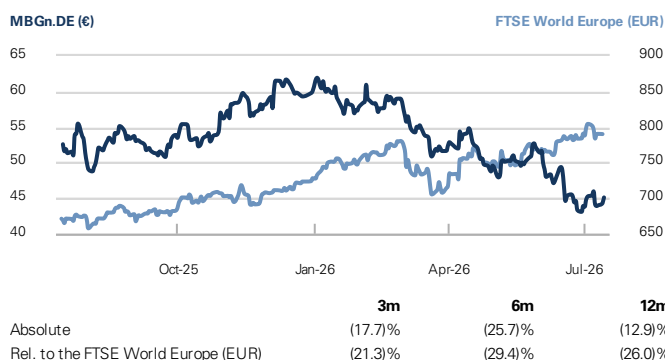
Rating since Nov 23, 2025

Ratios & Valuation

	12/25	12/26E	12/27E	12/28E
EV/sales (X)	0.6	0.5	0.5	0.5
EV/EBITDAR (X)	7.0	6.2	5.5	5.2
EV/EBITDA (excl. leases) (X)	7.0	6.2	5.5	5.2
EV/EBIT (X)	17.0	11.1	9.5	8.8
P/E (X)	10.2	8.1	6.6	5.7
FCF yield (%)	(13.1)	12.4	11.8	15.0
Dividend yield (%)	6.4	7.8	8.6	9.3
EV/GCI (X)	1.0	0.8	0.8	0.8
CROCI (%)	(0.7)	16.6	15.7	16.8
ROIC (%)	11.1	7.7	8.9	9.6
ROA (%)	1.9	2.0	2.3	2.6
Days inventory outst, sales	68.4	68.0	68.3	68.5
Asset turnover (X)	5.0	4.7	4.8	4.9
Net debt/equity (excl. leases) (%)	26.2	23.1	24.9	26.7
Capex/D&A (%)	137.0	122.2	109.5	106.3
FCF cover of dividends (X)	(2.2)	1.7	1.4	1.7

Growth & Margins (%)

	12/25	12/26E	12/27E	12/28E
Total revenue growth	(9.2)	(2.1)	2.4	2.5
EBITDA growth	(38.9)	15.8	3.7	4.6
EBIT growth	(63.1)	29.7	12.4	8.0
Net inc. growth	(49.6)	0.6	15.8	9.9
EPS growth	(47.6)	4.2	23.0	15.9
DPS growth	(18.6)	0.0	11.4	7.7

Price Performance

Source: FactSet. Price as of 14 Jul 2026 close.

Income Statement (€ mn)

	12/25	12/26E	12/27E	12/28E
Total revenue	132,214.0	129,414.6	132,545.6	135,794.7
Total operating expenses	(122,076.0)	(119,395.9)	(121,999.7)	(124,879.7)
R&D	(6,055.0)	(5,743.2)	(5,526.2)	(5,360.4)
Other operating inc./exp.)	526.0	1,703.4	1,703.4	1,703.4
EBITDA	11,700.0	13,543.5	14,041.7	14,681.2
Depreciation & amortisation	(7,091.0)	(7,564.6)	(7,318.6)	(7,423.3)
EBIT	4,609.0	5,978.8	6,723.0	7,258.0
Net interest inc./exp.)	464.0	381.1	192.5	275.6
Income/(loss) from associates	1,118.0	947.6	1,315.2	1,546.5
Profit/(loss) on disposals	—	—	—	—
Total other net	93.0	245.8	245.8	245.8
Pre-tax profit	6,284.0	7,553.3	8,476.5	9,325.8
Provision for taxes	(953.0)	(2,130.6)	(2,373.4)	(2,611.2)
Minority interest	(190.0)	(251.9)	(113.4)	(130.4)
Preferred dividends	—	—	—	—
Net inc. (pre-exceptionals)	5,141.0	5,170.9	5,989.7	6,584.2
Post-tax exceptionals	0.0	—	—	—
Net inc. (post-exceptionals)	5,141.0	5,170.9	5,989.7	6,584.2
EPS (basic, pre-except) (€)	5.34	5.57	6.85	7.94
EPS (basic, post-except) (€)	5.34	5.31	6.85	7.94
Wtd avg shares out. (basic) (mn)	962.4	974.2	875.0	829.5
Tax rate (%)	15.2	28.2	28.0	28.0
Common dividends declared	3,350.6	3,142.0	3,323.9	3,388.6
DPS (€)	3.50	3.50	3.90	4.20

Balance Sheet (€ mn)

	12/25	12/26E	12/27E	12/28E
Cash & cash equivalents	10,118.0	5,855.9	7,625.2	9,567.2
Accounts receivable	5,352.0	5,776.2	5,945.4	6,098.4
Inventory	23,787.0	24,461.0	25,149.9	25,798.1
Financial services assets	—	—	—	—
Other current assets	62,875.0	64,705.1	62,237.2	62,872.7
Total current assets	102,132.0	100,798.2	100,957.8	104,336.3
Net PP&E	26,987.3	27,918.9	27,862.3	27,777.2
Net intangibles	20,055.8	20,806.1	21,560.2	22,110.0
Total investments	16,413.0	17,315.0	15,315.0	13,315.0
Other long-term assets	89,878.0	89,617.7	86,821.8	87,541.7
Total assets	255,466.0	256,455.9	252,517.0	255,080.2
Accounts payable	9,890.0	11,696.2	11,924.1	12,231.5
Short-term debt	—	—	—	—
Short-term lease liabilities	—	—	—	—
Other current liabilities	63,878.0	64,239.8	62,552.3	63,179.6
Total current liabilities	73,768.0	75,936.0	74,476.4	75,411.1
Long-term debt	—	—	—	—
Long-term lease liabilities	—	—	—	—
Other long-term liabilities	87,458.0	87,482.5	84,553.4	85,306.7
Total long-term liabilities	87,458.0	87,482.5	84,553.4	85,306.7
Total liabilities	161,226.0	163,418.5	159,029.8	160,717.9
Preferred shares	—	—	—	—
Total common equity	93,257.0	91,961.0	92,388.2	93,237.2
Minority interest	983.0	1,076.4	1,099.1	1,125.1
Total liabilities & equity	255,466.0	256,455.9	252,517.0	255,080.2
Financial services adjustment	—	—	—	—

Cash Flow (€ mn)

	12/25	12/26E	12/27E	12/28E
Net income	5,141.0	5,170.9	5,989.7	6,584.2
D&A add-back	7,091.0	7,564.6	7,318.6	7,423.3
Minority interest add-back	—	—	—	—
Net (inc)/dec working capital	2,866.0	700.0	(630.2)	(493.7)
Other operating cash flow	(12,435.0)	1,398.0	107.3	165.2
Cash flow from operations	2,663.0	14,833.5	12,785.3	13,679.0
Capital expenditures	(9,714.0)	(9,246.6)	(8,016.2)	(7,888.0)
Acquisitions	—	—	—	—
Divestitures	—	—	—	—
Others	2,731.0	(503.0)	2,000.0	2,000.0
Cash flow from investing	(6,360.0)	(9,771.6)	(6,016.2)	(5,888.0)
Repayment of lease liabilities	—	—	—	—
Dividends paid (common & pref)	(4,140.0)	(3,409.8)	(3,062.5)	(3,235.2)
Inc/(dec) in debt	(145.0)	32.0	13.6	(4.4)
Other financing cash flows	918.0	(4,887.1)	(1,950.9)	(2,609.5)
Cash flow from financing	2,100.0	(8,924.9)	(4,999.9)	(5,849.1)
Total cash flow	(3,194.0)	(7,726.1)	3,538.5	3,883.9
Reinvestment rate (%)	NM	65.4	59.8	55.7

Source: Company data, Goldman Sachs Research estimates.

RoE remains well above the 10-12% guidance (GSe 12.8%). At the Group level, 2Q adj. EBIT is expected within the range, but the reported figure may be impacted by the continued assessment of the carrying value of investments (i.e., potential non-cash charges). 2Q free cash flow should remain positive, albeit at a lower level than 1Q, according to the management.

- **China remains the largest swing factor.** Management flagged intensifying pressure on both volume and pricing in China. The 1Q MSRP adjustment helped dealer profitability, but 2Q profit deteriorated significantly, and further dealer payments in 2H cannot be ruled out if the trend persists. Management also mentioned an ongoing review of the carrying amount of participations, which could trigger a non-cash impairment, in our view. On a more encouraging note, the electric GLC is launching in China with an entry model at RMB 299k - attractive pricing, in our view - and management reports strong pre-order numbers with high conversion.
- **Share buyback not contingent on the timing of M&A proceeds.** Management said it would pursue partial monetisation of its Daimler Truck (DTG) stake if opportunities arise, but pointed out that the next buyback tranche is not contingent on a DTG book-build. The last program (€2bn from Nov-25, up to 12 months) was accelerated and concluded by end-Jun-26, implying €3bn of remaining scope within the authorised €5bn program. Given Mercedes' balance sheet strength, we are more optimistic on a further program and forecast €3.1bn of SBB in total for FY26 (cons: €2.3bn).

Exhibit 1: Mercedes estimate changes, new vs. old

€ mn	2026E			2027E			2028E			2026-28E		
	New	Old	% chg	New	Old	% chg	New	Old	% chg	New	Old	% chg
Revenues												
Mercedes Cars	93,888	94,531	-0.7%	96,536	97,191	-0.7%	99,298	99,976	-0.7%	289,721	291,698	-0.7%
Mercedes Vans	17,427	17,283	0.8%	17,602	17,457	0.8%	17,779	17,632	0.8%	52,808	52,372	0.8%
Financial Services	24,581	24,994	-1.7%	25,073	25,494	-1.7%	25,574	26,004	-1.7%	75,228	76,493	-1.7%
Reconciliation	-6,482	-5,890	-10.0%	-6,665	-6,056	-10.0%	-6,855	-6,230	-10.0%	-20,002	-18,176	-10.0%
Group	129,415	130,918	-1.1%	132,546	134,086	-1.1%	135,795	137,382	-1.2%	397,755	402,386	-1.2%
Adj. EBIT												
Mercedes Cars	3,756	3,974	-5.5%	4,730	5,637	-16.1%	5,461	6,248	-12.6%	13,947	15,860	-12.1%
Mercedes Vans	1,637	1,580	3.6%	1,672	1,789	-6.5%	1,742	1,939	-10.2%	5,052	5,309	-4.8%
Financial Services	1,367	1,359	0.6%	1,348	1,348	0.0%	1,297	1,300	-0.2%	4,011	4,007	0.1%
Reconciliation	379	623	-39.2%	666	606	10.0%	686	623	10.0%	1,731	1,852	-6.5%
Group	7,139	7,537	-5.3%	8,416	9,380	-10.3%	9,186	10,111	-9.1%	24,742	27,027	-8.5%
Adj. EBIT Margin												
Mercedes Cars	4.0%	4.2%	-0.2%	4.9%	5.8%	-0.9%	5.5%	6.3%	-0.7%	4.8%	5.4%	-0.6%
Mercedes Vans	9.4%	9.1%	0.3%	9.5%	10.3%	-0.7%	9.8%	11.0%	-1.2%	9.6%	10.1%	-0.6%
Financial Services	5.6%	5.4%	0.1%	5.4%	5.3%	0.1%	5.1%	5.0%	0.1%	5.3%	5.2%	0.1%
Reconciliation	-5.9%	-10.6%	4.7%	-10.0%	-10.0%	0.0%	-10.0%	-10.0%	0.0%	-8.7%	-10.2%	1.5%
Group	5.5%	5.8%	-0.2%	6.3%	7.0%	-0.6%	6.8%	7.4%	-0.6%	6.2%	6.7%	-0.5%
Diluted EPS (reported)												
DPS	5.57	5.81	-4.1%	6.85	7.41	-7.6%	7.94	8.41	-5.7%	20.35	21.63	-5.9%
DPS	3.50	3.50	0.0%	3.90	3.90	0.0%	4.20	4.20	0.0%	11.6	11.60	0.0%
Ind FCF												
Ind. Net Liquidity	4,669	4,902	-4.7%	4,769	5,999	-20.5%	5,791	8,709	-33.5%	15,229	19,610	-22.3%
Ind. Net Liquidity	21,530	20,524	4.9%	23,299	21,385	9.0%	25,241	24,090	4.8%	70,070	65,999	6.2%

Source: Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

Exhibit 2: GSe vs. Visible Alpha Consensus Data

€ mn	2Q26E			2026E			2027E			2028E			2026-28E		
	GSe	Cons	GSe vs. Cons	GSe	Cons	GSe vs. Cons	GSe	Cons	GSe vs. Cons	GSe	Cons	GSe vs. Cons	Gse	Cons	GSe vs. Cons
Revenues							Guide 2026 onwards +7% CAGR								
Mercedes Cars	22,869	23,082	-0.9%	93,888	94,724	-0.9%	96,536	97,979	-1.5%	99,298	99,943	-0.6%	289,721	292,647	-1.0%
Mercedes Vans	4,312	4,353	-0.9%	17,427	17,592	-0.9%	17,602	18,300	-3.8%	17,779	18,903	-5.9%	52,808	54,794	-3.6%
Financial Services	6,342	6,318	0.4%	24,581	24,410	0.7%	25,073	24,776	1.2%	25,574	25,282	1.2%	75,228	74,469	1.0%
Reconciliation	-1,579	-1,510	-4.5%	-6,482	-5,934	-9.2%	-6,665	-6,079	-9.6%	-6,855	-6,160	-11.3%	-20,002	-18,174	-10.1%
Group	31,944	32,313	-1.1%	129,415	130,904	-1.1%	132,546	135,270	-2.0%	135,795	138,700	-2.1%	397,755	404,875	-1.8%
				Guide 129.6-134.8bn											
Adj. EBIT															
Mercedes Cars	778	816	-4.7%	3,756	3,539	6.1%	4,730	4,997	-5.3%	5,461	6,119	-10.7%	13,947	14,655	-4.8%
Mercedes Vans	397	393	0.8%	1,637	1,608	1.8%	1,672	1,794	-6.8%	1,742	1,874	-7.0%	5,052	5,276	-4.3%
Financial Services	426	314	36.0%	1,367	1,298	5.3%	1,348	1,313	2.6%	1,297	1,356	-4.4%	4,011	3,968	1.1%
Reconciliation	118	92	N/A	379	345	10.0%	666	492	35.4%	686	470	45.8%	1,731	1,307	32.4%
Group	1,719	1,592	8.0%	7,139	6,926	3.1%	8,416	8,730	-3.6%	9,186	9,991	-8.1%	24,742	25,647	-3.5%
Adj. EBIT Margin				Guide 3-5%			Mid-term guide 8-10%								
Mercedes Cars	3.4%	3.5%	-0.1%	4.0%	3.7%	0.3%	4.9%	5.1%	-0.2%	5.5%	6.1%	-0.6%	4.8%	5.0%	-0.2%
Mercedes Vans	9.2%	9.0%	0.2%	9.4%	9.1%	0.3%	9.5%	9.8%	-0.3%	9.8%	9.9%	-0.1%	9.6%	9.6%	-0.1%
Financial Services	6.7%	5.0%	1.8%	5.6%	5.3%	0.2%	5.4%	5.3%	0.1%	5.1%	5.4%	-0.3%	5.3%	5.3%	0.0%
Reconciliation	-7.5%	-6.1%	-1.4%	-5.9%	-5.8%	0.0%	-10.0%	-8.1%	-1.9%	-10.0%	-7.6%	-2.4%	-8.7%	-7.2%	-1.5%
Group	5.4%	4.9%	0.5%	5.5%	5.3%	0.2%	6.3%	6.5%	-0.1%	6.8%	7.2%	-0.4%	6.2%	6.3%	-0.1%
Diluted EPS (reported)	1.43	1.29	11.0%	5.57	5.58	-0.3%	6.85	7.17	-4.5%	7.94	8.34	-4.9%	20.35	21.09	-3.5%
DPS	N/A	N/A	N/A	3.50	3.32	5.5%	3.90	3.48	12.2%	4.20	3.78	11.0%	11.6	10.58	-3.5%
				Guide 4.1-4.9bn											
Ind FCF	905	-789	214.6%	4,669	4,422	5.6%	4,769	4,532	5.2%	5,791	5,466	5.9%	15,229	14,420	5.6%
Ind. Net Liquidity	21,404	N/A	N/A	21,530	N/A	N/A	23,299	N/A	N/A	25,241	N/A	N/A			

Source: Visible Alpha Consensus Data, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

Exhibit 3: MBG price target calculation

In €

MBG Price Target Calculation	
P/E valuation framework	
6M27/6M28E EPS, €	7.39
Target P/E multiple	7.5x
PT based on P/E valuation, €	55
Daimler Truck investment stake framework	
NPV of future proceeds over 5 years, €mn	9,478
DTG WACC assumption	8.5%
MBG's share count in DTG, mn	961
Value add from DTG investment stake, €	10
Target Price, €	65

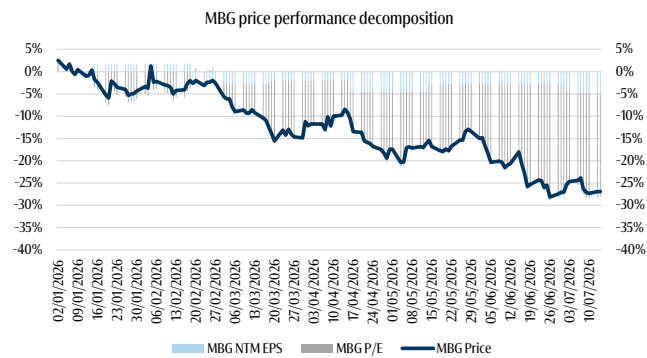
Source: Company data, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

Valuation and risks

Valuation: We value Mercedes on a hybrid P/E and Daimler Truck (DTG) investment stake framework to explicitly account for the value of the remaining DTG stake. Our 12m price target is **€65** (from €66) and comprises: (1) €55 per share (from €56) from applying a 7.5x target multiple on a 50/50 blend of FY27/28E EPS; and (2) €10 per share (unchanged) from the NPV of MBG's DTG stake, assuming an orderly sell-down over five years with proceeds returned to shareholders via MBG share buybacks. We remain **Buy** rated.

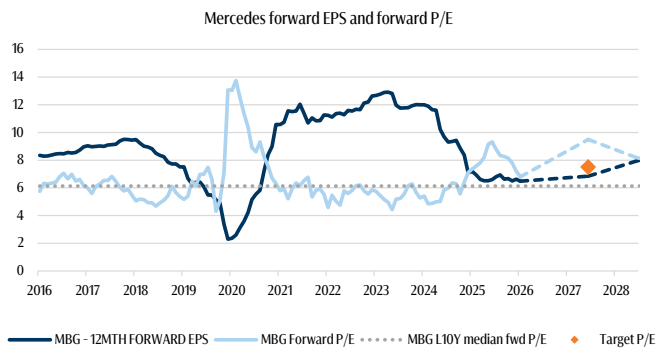
Key downside risks to our view and price target: Deviation from luxury strategy/focus; slowdown and/or restrictions in key luxury markets; cost savings do not materialise; inability to reduce capex; DTG stake monetisation may be slower or at lower prices than assumed due to market conditions reducing distributable cash and buyback capacity.

Exhibit 4: Mercedes’ YTD price performance is primarily explained by multiple contraction.
Mercedes 26YTD price performance decomposition



Source: LSEG, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

Exhibit 5: Mercedes is currently trading close to its 10-year historical median.
Mercedes 12m forward EPS (€) and P/E (x)



Source: LSEG, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

Disclosure Appendix

Reg AC

We, Christian Frenes, Monika Mengting Liu, CFA, Shivam Kotecha and Robert Triulzi, hereby certify that all of the views expressed in this report accurately reflect our personal views about the subject company or companies and its or their securities. We also certify that no part of our compensation was, is or will be, directly or indirectly, related to the specific recommendations or views expressed in this report.

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Contributing Authors: Christian Frenes Goldman Sachs International, Monika Mengting Liu, CFA Goldman Sachs International, Shivam Kotecha Goldman Sachs India SPL, Robert Triulzi Goldman Sachs International.

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GS Factor Profile

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Growth is based on a stock's forward-looking sales growth, EBITDA growth and EPS growth (for financial stocks, only EPS and sales growth), with a higher percentile indicating a higher growth company. **Financial Returns** is based on a stock's forward-looking ROE, ROCE and CROCI (for financial stocks, only ROE), with a higher percentile indicating a company with higher financial returns. **Multiple** is based on a stock's forward-looking P/E, P/B, price/dividend (P/D), EV/EBITDA, EV/FCF and EV/Debt Adjusted Cash Flow (DACF) (for financial stocks, only P/E, P/B and P/D), with a higher percentile indicating a stock trading at a higher multiple. The **Integrated** percentile is calculated as the average of the Growth percentile, Financial Returns percentile and (100% - Multiple percentile).

Financial Returns and Multiple use the Goldman Sachs analyst forecasts at the fiscal year-end at least three quarters in the future. Growth uses inputs for the fiscal year at least seven quarters in the future compared with the year at least three quarters in the future (on a per-share basis for all metrics).

For a more detailed description of how we calculate the GS Factor Profile, please contact your GS representative.

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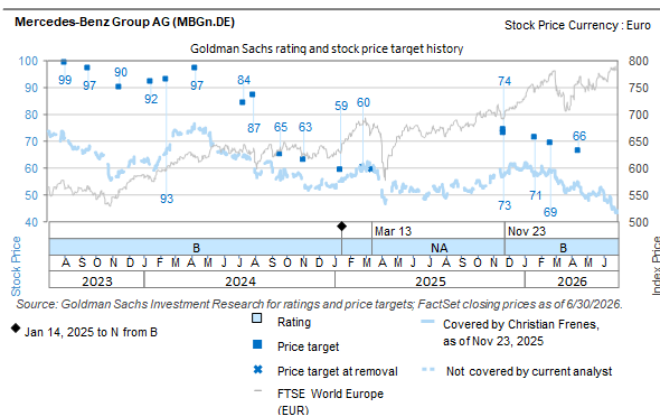
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Goldman Sachs Investment Research global Equity coverage universe

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Target price history table(s)

Mercedes-Benz Group AG (MBGn.DE)

Date of report	Target price (€)	Closing price (€)
16-Apr-26	66.00	53.35
20-Feb-26	69.00	59.24
23-Jan-26	71.00	58.30
24-Nov-25	73.00	57.49
23-Nov-25	74.00	57.02
25-Feb-25	60.00	60.70
14-Jan-25	59.00	55.55
05-Nov-24	63.00	55.90
20-Sep-24	65.00	54.99
31-Jul-24	87.00	61.16
12-Jul-24	84.00	64.78
11-Apr-24	97.00	75.74
14-Feb-24	93.00	65.53
16-Jan-24	92.00	61.28
17-Nov-23	90.00	58.60
18-Sep-23	97.00	66.44
02-Aug-23	99.00	71.05

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